

Missouri State Epidemiological Profile July 2018

MO Behavioral Health Epidemiology
Workgroup
(MO-BHEW)



Missouri

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Missouri Substance Use – Key Findings



Alcohol Use

51.4% of all Missourians aged 12 and older reported using alcohol in the past month while 24.9% reported binge drinking in the same time period.

These numbers have remained relatively steady over the last decade; the binge rate is slightly higher than the national average.



Tobacco Use

25.1% of all Missourians aged 12 and older reported smoking cigarettes in the past month. This is a number that remains well above the national average (20.1%).

Missouri has been higher than the national average for rate of deaths due to tobacco use for the last decade.



Marijuana Use

8.1% of all Missourians aged 12 and older reported using marijuana in the past month. This is a number that has increased slightly over the past few years and is similar to the national average.

Missouri has been higher than the national average for number of property crimes for the last decade. Rates for both Missouri and the US are trending downward.

Missouri Mental Health – Key Findings

Depression



Rates for adults having at least one major depression episode are typically higher in Missouri than nationally.

22.7% of Missouri youth said they were sad in the last month “often” or “always” while 13.5% said they felt hopeless about their future.

Suicide

Missouri has been higher than the national average for rate of deaths due to suicide for the last decade, and the rate continues to climb.

9.9% of Missouri youth made a plan to die by suicide.

LGBTQ & Military



Students who identify as LGBTQ are twice as likely as students identifying as straight to report having suicidal thoughts or feeling sad or depressed “often” or “always”.

Although stable over time, suicide rates in Missouri among veterans are more than double those among civilians.



Introduction

Missouri is located in the Midwest. The geography of the state is largely rural, although over half of the population clusters around two metropolitan areas. Slightly over six million people make Missouri their home making it the 18th most populated state. Twenty-three percent (23.0%) of the population is under 18 years old, 61.7% are ages 19-64 and 15.3% are 65 and older. The population is primarily white (82.5%) with African Americans making up the second largest group (11.6%). Hispanics are a small group (3.9%), but growing. Less than 4% of the population is foreign born and approximately 2% of the households are limited English speaking.¹

Slightly over eleven percent (11.2%) of the adult population do not have a high school diploma while only 27.6% have graduated from a 4-year college. Over a third (36.7%) of the population ages 16 and older are not in the labor force. Around fifteen percent (15.3%) of the households fall below the poverty level. The median household income is \$49,593 and 18.4% of the population spend at least a third of their income on housing.¹

The Missouri Department of Mental Health (DMH), Division of Behavioral Health (DBH) is the state authority responsible for developing and implementing a statewide response addressing the impact of substance use disorder on Missouri families and communities. The DBH works collaboratively with other state and local agencies to ensure that the Missouri's response is comprehensive and appropriate. In the fall 2010, DBH submitted a request for a subcontract through Synectics to the Center for

¹ <https://factfinder.census.gov/faces/tableservices/jsf/pages/productview.xhtml?src=CF> U.S. Census Bureau, 2012-2016 American Community Survey 5-Year Estimates

Substance Abuse Prevention (CSAP), a part of the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration (SAMHSA), to increase the epidemiological capacity of the state. As a result, the state was awarded a grant and formed the Missouri Behavioral Health Epidemiology Workgroup (MO-BHEW). One of the products of the MO-BHEW is a State Epidemiological Profile. The first Profile was completed Spring 2011. The State Epidemiological Profile provides an overview of the current available data on substance use and mental health across the state, including subpopulation data where possible. In addition, it discusses available Risk and Protective Factor data for the state, data gaps that need to be addressed, and final conclusions on the condition of the state.

For the past 16 years, the DMH has also produced an annual Status Report with data on alcohol and drug use across the state. The Status Report includes data from national surveys as well as available local data. This historical data collection, in combination with the indicators suggested by the federal funders, led to the choice of indicators covered throughout this report.

Lastly, MO-BHEW identified two high-risk subpopulations, lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender or queer (LGBTQ) individuals and military personnel. While mental health and substance use data on these subpopulations are difficult to find, what is available is presented in this report.

Key Substance Use Measures



Alcohol Consumption

Drinking Rates

In 2015-16, 51.4% of all Missourians aged 12 and older reported using alcohol in the past month. This is a number that has remained relatively steady over the last decade and is similar to the national average.

Over nine percent (9.9%) of Missourians aged 12-17 years reported drinking in the last month. This compares to 59.0% of 18-25 year olds and 55.1% in the 26+ age group.

Those in the 18-25 year old age group are most likely to have reported drinking in the past month although the gap between the adult groups has been decreasing. Those aged 12-17 years continue a slight decrease in use in the previous month.

Figure 1: Estimated Past-Month Alcohol Use (%): U.S. and Missouri Ages 12 and Older, 2002-2016

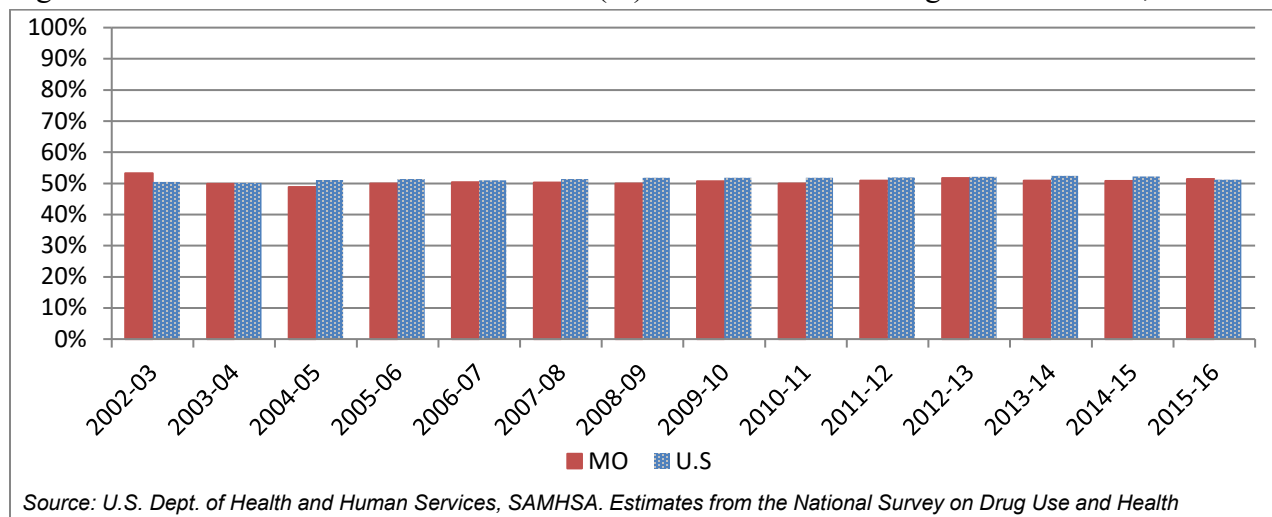
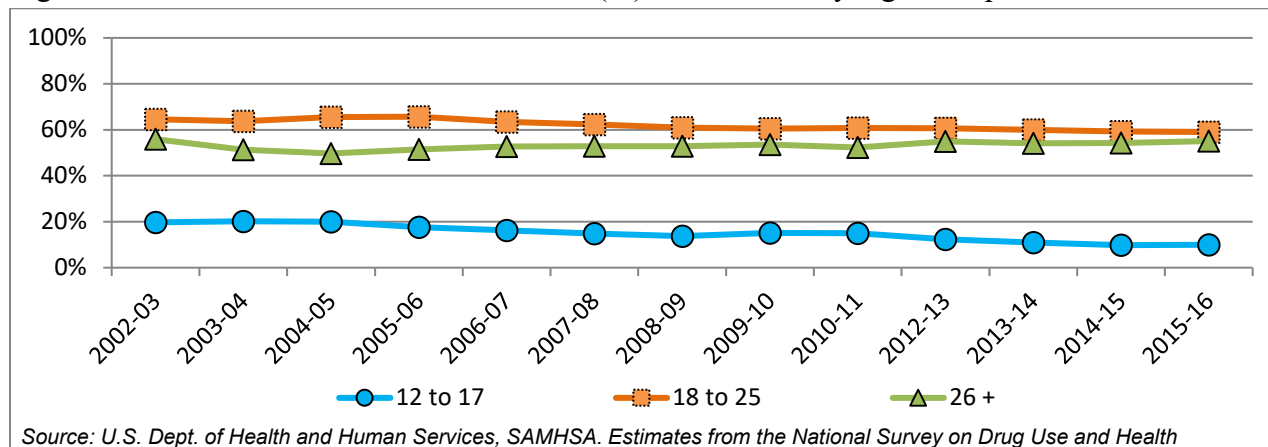


Figure 2: Estimated Past-Month Alcohol Use (%): In Missouri by Age Group, 2002-2016



Age of First Use

In 2015, less than one in five (17.3%) of all students currently in high school reported having their first drink of alcohol before the age of 13. This percentage has been decreasing over the last decade and is similar to the U.S average.

Males consistently report a higher percentage of drinking before age 13 than females. In 2015, the percentage of males initiating drinking before age 13 was 20.5% compared to 14.2% for females.

Missouri data for 2011 is not available.

Figure 3: % Students in 9-12 Grades Reporting First Use of Alcohol Before Age 13, U.S. and Missouri, 1999-2015

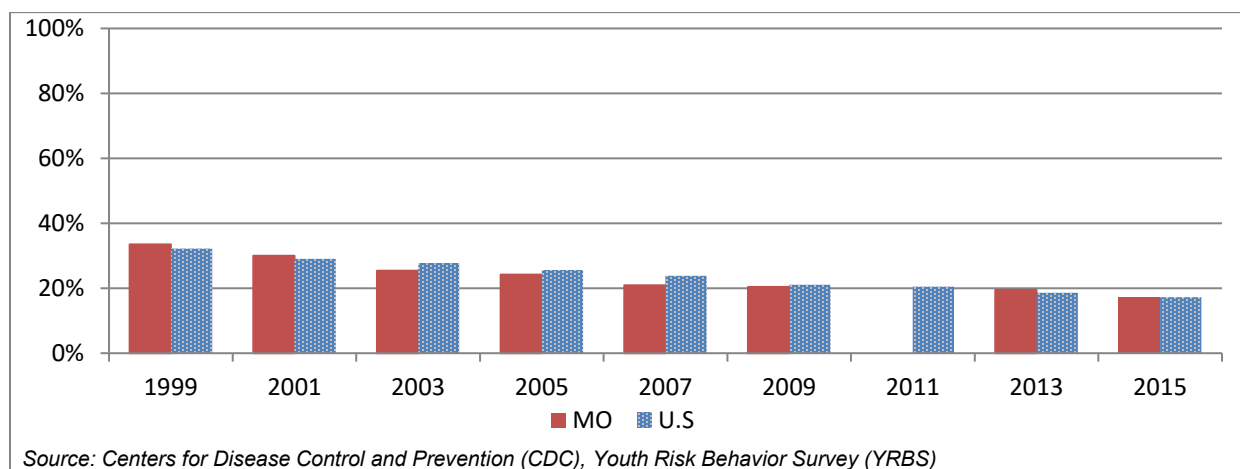
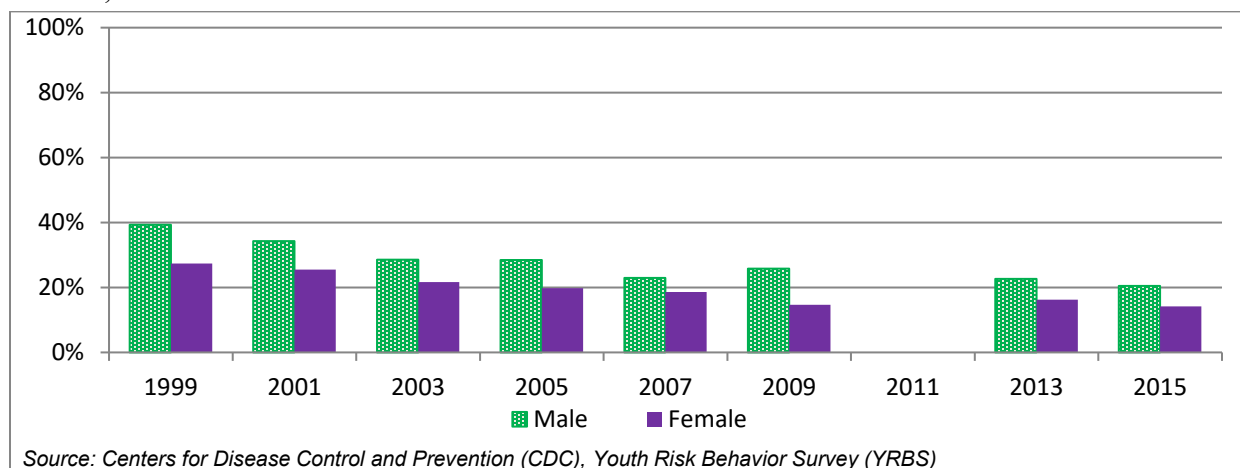


Figure 4: % Students in 9-12 Grades Reporting First Use of Alcohol Before Age 13: In Missouri by Gender, 1999-2015



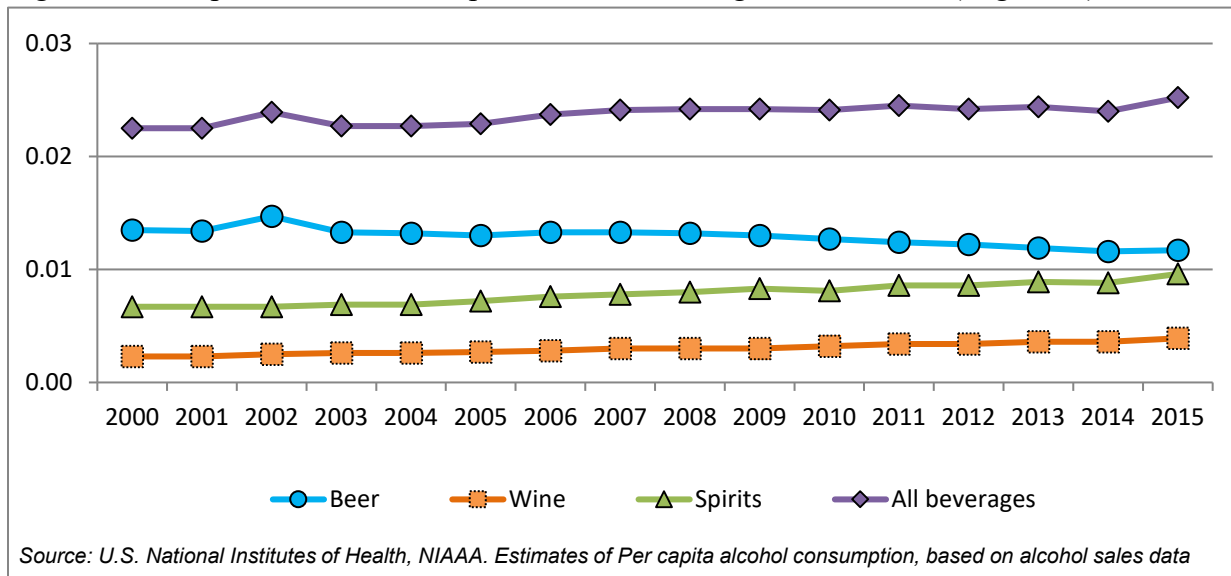
Per Capita Ethanol Consumption

Per Capita data should be interpreted cautiously – it may not be sensitive in identifying areas where a high prevalence of heavy use is also seen with high rates of abstinence.

The overall pattern of per capita ethanol consumption for Missouri is similar to that of the nation as a whole.²

Beer has the highest consumption rate for the state although the gap between that and wine / spirits has been decreasing.

Figure 5: Per capita ethanol consumption for Missouri, ages 14 and older (in gallons), 2000-2015



² <http://dmh.mo.gov/docs/ada/statusreport2015-c11.pdf>

Binge Drinking

In 2015, the National Survey on Drug Use and Health (NSDUH) increased the threshold for determining binge alcohol use for females from 5+ drinks on one occasion to 4+ drinks on one occasion. Therefore, data from before 2015 are not comparable to current data.

In 2015-16, 25.1% of Missourians aged 12 and older reported binge drinking in the past month. This is slightly above as the national average (24.6 %).

In 2015-16, 5.6% of Missourians aged 12-17 reported binge drinking in the last month. This compares to 40.6% of the 18-25 year olds and 24.8% in the 26+ age group.

As seen with overall drinking rates, those in the 18-25 year old age group are also most likely to have reported binge drinking in the past month.

While this number had started to decrease since 2005, it slightly increased over the last 4 years. There is a decrease in reported binge drinking among people aged 12-17 year olds over the last decade.

Figure 6: Estimated Past-Month Binge Drinking (%): U.S. and Missouri Ages 12 and Older, 2002-2014.
NOTE: NSDUH refined definition of “binge drinking” in 2015.

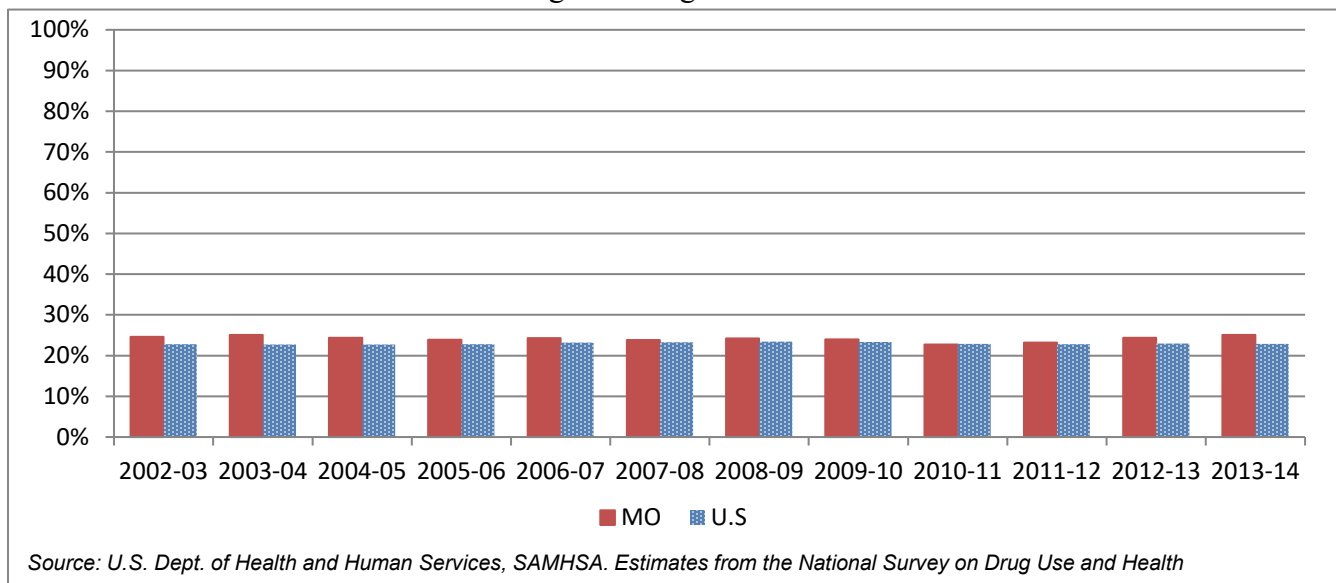
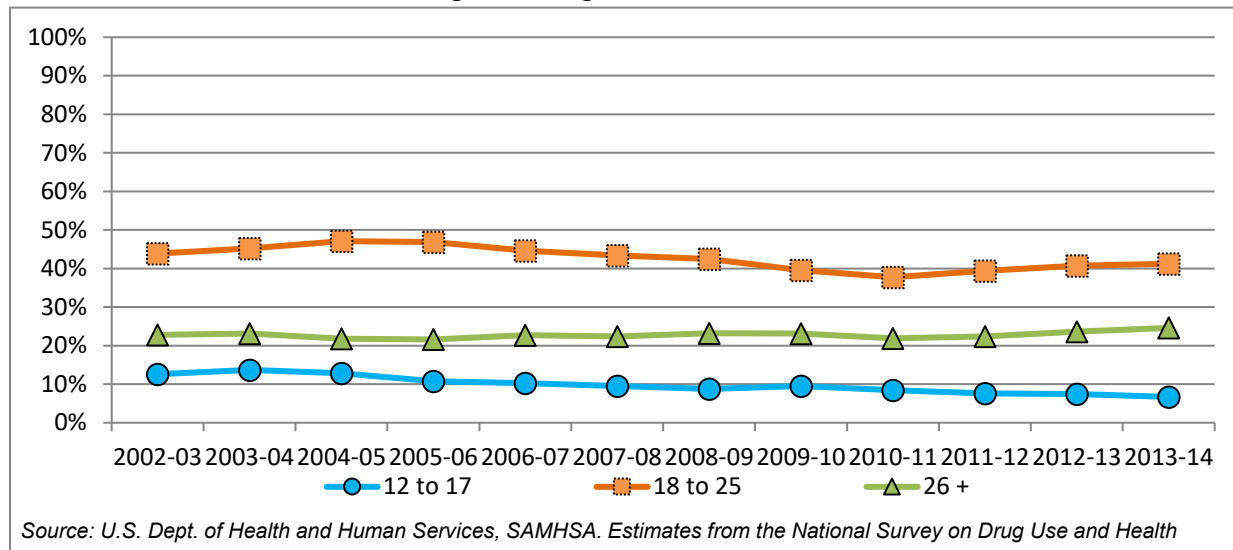


Figure 7: Estimated Past-Month Binge Drinking (%): In Missouri by Age Group, 2002-2014. NOTE: NSDUH refined definition of “binge drinking” in 2015.



When comparing the percentage of people who reported any drinking to those who reported binge drinking, it becomes clear that binge drinking is a concern, especially in the younger age groups. Of those under 25 who reported drinking in the last 30 days, over half of them engaged in at least one session of binge drinking.

Table 1: Comparison of 30 Day and Binge Drinking in Missouri, 2015-2016

Age Group	% of Sample Reporting 30 day Use	% of Sample Reporting Binging in the last 30 days
12-17	9.9%	5.6%
18-25	59.0%	40.6%
26+	55.1%	27.0%

Source: U.S. Dept. of Health and Human Services, SAMHSA. Estimates from the National Survey on Drug Use and Health.

Drinking and Pregnancy

Prior reports have stated that PRAMS data are not available for Missouri. Instead they contained information from the Missouri Department of Health and Senior Services. However, in 2009 MDHSS stopped collecting these data.

PRAMS data began to be reported in 2007 (data not available for 2008) and so was chosen as a replacement for the DHSS data. However, these data have not been updated since 2011.

As the latest data available are now from 2011, this report does not have any new information to report on maternal drinking and pregnancy. See prior reports if older data are needed.